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Reflection of Identity
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As a white, heterosexual, cis-gender person with a bachelor's degree and a middle-class household income, I recognize that I have quite a bit of privilege. Still, I lack privilege in many aspects, as I am also a neurodevelopmentally disabled woman who grew up poor and is a first generation college student. I feel like this gives me both compassion for others and a responsibility to effect positive change where I can.

I believe that information should be freely accessible to everyone and that libraries, as places to access information, cannot be neutral without compromising accessibility (Price, 2021). Allowing hate to have a space in a library is going to create a barrier for anyone who feels uncomfortable or unsafe.

Learning from the experiences of others is an excellent way to reduce bias and broaden thinking. While I prefer to work independently on projects, the reality of library work is that collaboration is a critical part of the work that we do. Even if I am the only person responsible for a project, ultimately the work will need to be integrated into a whole to be meaningful. (e.g. I make a catalog record for a book, but the director budgets the funds for it; other librarians select, display, and market it; and front desk staff might suggest it to patrons.)

For me, a good librarian is someone who puts aside their own biases and beliefs to help others access information. That said, being a good librarian is not necessarily the same thing as being a good person (though there is definitely overlap), and I think that there needs to be a balance between platforming all viewpoints equally and creating spaces that are safe for all patrons. This balance is a constantly changing target, but ultimately, I should be using my perspective and my privilege to collaborate with others in my profession to make sure that the library spaces I have influence over are safe for everyone to be in.

Price, S. (2021, June 28). The myth of neutrality: Academic libraries balance freedom of expression with psychological safety. *American Libraries*. https://americanlibrariesmagazine.org/blogs/the-scoop/the-myth-of-neutrality/